



ADNAN SHAMIM

AGENTIC AI GOVERNANCE

INTERNAL AUDIT ECOSYSTEM™



TWO COMPLEMENTARY FRAMEWORKS. TWO DISTINCT PURPOSES. ONE ACCOUNTABILITY ARCHITECTURE.

STRATEGY DEFINES WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN.
ASSURANCE INDEPENDENTLY EVALUATES WHETHER IT OPERATED AS INTENDED—
AND WHETHER SUFFICIENT **EVIDENCE** SUPPORTS THAT CONCLUSION.

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

Structures Agentic AI strategy, decision boundaries, operating models, execution, and human accountability.

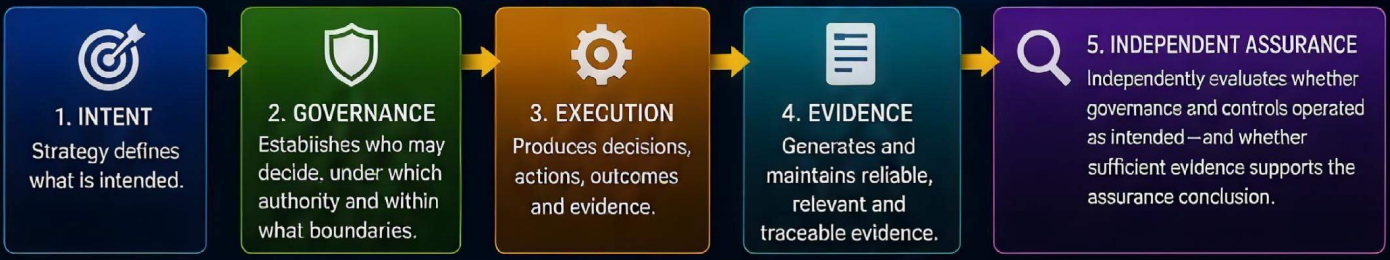


THE I-A-N-E-T-F CONE FRAMEWORK™

Structures independent assurance around authority, evidence, control execution, traceability, and demonstrable accountability.



THE DISTINCTION IS FUNDAMENTAL



WHAT THIS ECOSYSTEM ENSURES

- ✓ Clear separation of Strategy (Management) and Assurance (Internal Audit).
- ✓ Defined decision boundaries and human oversight.
- ✓ End-to-end traceability and immutable evidence.
- ✓ Independent evaluation, testing, and assurance.
- ✓ Demonstrable and defensible accountability.



WHAT THIS ECOSYSTEM DOES NOT DO

- ✗ Does not replace management accountability.
- ✗ Does not replace governance, risk management, internal controls, or compliance functions.
- ✗ Does not guarantee outcomes or eliminate risk.
- ✗ Does not limit professional judgment or audit independence.



THE OBJECTIVE IS NOT TO ASSUME CONTROL.
IT IS TO DEFINE IT, GOVERN IT, OPERATE IT,
EVIDENCE IT, TEST IT, AND INDEPENDENTLY ASSURE IT.



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The Futurist's Strategy Cone™
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Driving Responsible Agentic AI Through Strategy, Governance and Independent Assurance.



SCAN TO EXPLORE THE FRAMEWORKS

THE POLICY- ARCHITECTURE GAP IN AGENTIC AI

**A policy can say “STOP.”
But can the system actually stop the
agent from executing controlled
actions?**

That is the real assurance question.

In traditional environments, documented policies and procedures often formed a significant part of the control framework.

With **Agentic AI**, documentation alone is not enough.

POLICY

Defines what the organization **requires, approves, and authorizes**.

ARCHITECTURE + TECHNICAL CONTROLS

Determine what the AI system can **actually execute** within its authorized environment.

ENFORCEMENT

Translates approved requirements into **technical constraints at decision and execution boundaries**.

EVIDENCE

Makes decisions, actions, changes, exceptions, and overrides **traceable and independently testable**.

REVOCATION

Tests whether authorized capabilities can be **effectively withdrawn when required**.

THE INTERNAL AUDIT SHIFT

Don't audit only what the policy **says**.

Audit what the system can **actually do**.

Ask:

- Who authorized the agent?
- What decisions may it make autonomously?
- Where are human approval boundaries required?
- Are those boundaries technically enforced?
- Can decisions and actions be independently reconstructed?
- Are boundary changes authorized, controlled, and traceable?
- Can controlled authority be revoked—and can effective revocation be demonstrated?

This is where **The Futurist's Strategy Cone™** and **The I-A-N-E-T-F Cone Framework™** provide complementary perspectives:

Strategic Direction → Decision

Architecture → Execution Boundaries →

Control Evidence → Independent Assurance

The objective is **not to replace policy with architecture.**

It is to close the gap between **approved intent and executable reality.**

**Policy defines the approved intent.
Architecture and technical controls enforce the boundary.**

Evidence demonstrates operation.

Revocation tests the control under withdrawal.

Internal Audit provides independent assurance.

THE REAL TEST

A documented stop procedure is **not the same as demonstrated revocation.**

The critical question is not:

“Do we have a policy to stop the agent?”

It is:

“Can management demonstrate that the agent operates within its authorized boundaries—and that its controlled authority can be effectively revoked when required?”

AI may execute.

Management remains accountable.

Internal Audit remains independent.

Documented control describes the requirement.

Enforced control constrains execution.

Assurance determines whether the control actually works.

SO, WHAT GOVERNS YOUR AGENTIC AI?

**The policy you wrote—
or the controls your architecture
actually enforces?**

